FOR MANAGERS AND OWNERS

Manager toolkit

Simple, printable tools to reinforce learning on the shop floor. Each takes a few minutes and uses the same three-level rubric, so lessons, coaching and assessment all speak one language.

OUR PRINCIPLE

Protect the company and benefit the customer.

TOOL 1

Customer conversation and fitting observation rubric

Use it for any real or role-played interaction. Tick one level per row. It is the same rubric used in lessons, coaching and the practical assessment.

Team member _____ **Observed by** _____

Date _____ **Real or role-play** _____

Observation criteria	Not yet demonstrated	Demonstrated with support	Demonstrated independently
Discovery and listening Welcomes, asks about activity, comfort and what is not working, and listens before showing product.			
Appropriate assessment Chooses a suitable assessment (hand measure or scan), measures both feet and fits the larger one.			
Clear explanation Explains findings in plain, neutral words linked to what the customer said. No diagnosis.			
Relevant recommendation Offers two or three suitable options, is open about price, and suggests extras only for a relevant need.			
Fit validation and customer choice The customer tries, walks and compares. The customer makes the decision.			
Professional boundaries No medical claims, refers ongoing pain, no pressure after a no, honest about stock and policy.			

One observed strength _____

One improvement _____

One next action _____

Critical errors (always record, always correct): an unsupported diagnosis or medical claim, an unsafe recommendation, or pressure after the customer declines.

TOOL 2

New-starter capability checklist

Work through it in the first four weeks. Sign off a row only when you have seen it, not when it has been explained.

Team member _____ **Start date** _____

Manager _____ **Target review date** _____

Week	Capability	Level seen	Date	Initials
1	Welcomes customers and asks about activity and comfort before showing product			
1	Summarises the customer's needs in one sentence and confirms them			
2	Measures both feet and fits the larger one			
2	Explains a measurement or scan in plain words, without diagnosing			
3	Lets the customer try, walk and compare before deciding			
3	States prices early and recommends extras only for a relevant need			
4	Responds calmly to a concern and respects a no			
4	Knows when to refer to a podiatrist or doctor			

Levels: Not yet demonstrated, Demonstrated with support, Demonstrated independently.

TOOL 3

Ten-minute huddle guide

Before opening or in a quiet moment. One skill per huddle. No slides needed.

Minutes 0 to 2

Focus

Name one skill and why it matters for customers this week.

Minutes 2 to 4

Show

Read the model conversation from the lesson, or demonstrate it yourself.

Minutes 4 to 8

Practise

Pairs role-play with a scenario card, then swap.

Minutes 8 to 10

Commit

Each person names one thing they will do on this shift.

Useful prompts

- What did the customer actually need?
- What would you say differently?
- How did the customer get to choose?

Record

Date _____ **Skill** _____

Who attended _____ **Follow-up** _____

TOOL 4

Scenario practice cards

Training scenarios, not real customer stories. Cut along the dashed lines. Use one card per pair.

TRAINING SCENARIO 1 OF 7

A customer who is unsure what they need

“I don’t really know what I need. Just show me something good.”

Try: Offer an easy way in: ask what they will mostly use the shoes for and how their current pair feels.

Avoid: Bringing the bestseller before you understand the need.

Discuss: Why does this response help or harm the customer?

TRAINING SCENARIO 2 OF 7

A customer with a limited budget

Their budget is $120. The closest match is $165.

Try: Show a suitable option within budget and the closer match, explain the difference honestly, let them try both.

Avoid: Showing only the dearer pair, or saying nothing suitable exists.

Discuss: Why does this response help or harm the customer?

TRAINING SCENARIO 3 OF 7

A customer who disagrees with a scan explanation

“That’s wrong. My feet are fine.”

Try: Respect their view, explain the scan only shows how they stand today, and let fit and feel decide.

Avoid: Arguing, repeating the findings, or naming a condition.

Discuss: Why does this response help or harm the customer?

TRAINING SCENARIO 4 OF 7

A suitable product is out of stock

The best match is not available in their size.

Try: Be honest, offer to order or hold it, and show one suitable alternative to try and compare.

Avoid: Fitting the wrong size or presenting the alternative as your first choice.

Discuss: Why does this response help or harm the customer?

TRAINING SCENARIO 5 OF 7

An additional product would not help

The customer is happy with a well-fitting shoe; an insole would not add meaningful benefit.

Try: Do not recommend it. Mention it only if their needs change.

Avoid: Adding it because it raises the sale.

Discuss: Why does this response help or harm the customer?

TRAINING SCENARIO 6 OF 7

An unhappy customer returning footwear

"You told me these would fix my pain."

Try: Listen, acknowledge, check the fit, explain options under store policy, and suggest a podiatrist if pain continues.

Avoid: Blaming the customer or promising another product will fix the pain.

Discuss: Why does this response help or harm the customer?

TRAINING SCENARIO 7 OF 7

A busy store with several customers waiting

Three people are waiting while you finish a fitting.

Try: Acknowledge the waiting customers briefly, give your customer a ten-second summary, and confirm before moving on.

Avoid: Walking away without a word, or skipping the summary.

Discuss: Why does this response help or harm the customer?

TOOL 5

Weekly coaching sheet

One sheet per team member per week. Observe one interaction, rate it on the rubric and agree one action.

Team member

Week of

Skill focus

Manager

This week's criteria	Not yet demonstrated	Demonstrated with support	Demonstrated independently
Discovery and listening Welcomes, asks about activity, comfort and what is not working, and listens before showing product.			
Appropriate assessment Chooses a suitable assessment (hand measure or scan), measures both feet and fits the larger one.			
Clear explanation Explains findings in plain, neutral words linked to what the customer said. No diagnosis.			
Relevant recommendation Offers two or three suitable options, is open about price, and suggests extras only for a relevant need.			
Fit validation and customer choice The customer tries, walks and compares. The customer makes the decision.			
Professional boundaries No medical claims, refers ongoing pain, no pressure after a no, honest about stock and policy.			

One observed strength

One improvement

One next action

Time guide: about 10 minutes to observe and 5 minutes to discuss.

TOOL 6

Practical assessment and assessor guide

Used for the Certified Fit Specialist practical assessment and for internal sign-off. The online exam (30 questions, 24 to pass) is separate and stays in place.

Two scenarios, both required

- **Scenario A, standard fitting:** a customer on their feet all day; assess, explain, recommend and validate.
- **Scenario B, difficult interaction:** the customer disagrees with the scan, has a limited budget, and an extra product would not help them.

Pass criteria

- Every criterion rated at least **Demonstrated with support**
- At least four of six criteria **Demonstrated independently**
- No critical errors in either scenario

Assessment criteria	Not yet demonstrated	Demonstrated with support	Demonstrated independently
Discovery and listening Welcomes, asks about activity, comfort and what is not working, and listens before showing product.			
Appropriate assessment Chooses a suitable assessment (hand measure or scan), measures both feet and fits the larger one.			
Clear explanation Explains findings in plain, neutral words linked to what the customer said. No diagnosis.			
Relevant recommendation Offers two or three suitable options, is open about price, and suggests extras only for a relevant need.			
Fit validation and customer choice The customer tries, walks and compares. The customer makes the decision.			
Professional boundaries			

Assessment criteria	Not yet demonstrated	Demonstrated with support	Demonstrated independently
No medical claims, refers ongoing pain, no pressure after a no, honest about stock and policy.			

Critical errors mean correction and reassessment: an unsupported diagnosis or medical claim, an unsafe recommendation, or pressure after the customer declines. Give feedback the same day, agree one coaching action, and reassess with a different scenario after at least seven days of practice.

Scoring examples: clear explanation

- **Independently:** “This shows more pressure at the front, which fits the aching you mentioned.”
- **With support:** correct, but needed a prompt to link it to the customer.
- **Not yet:** reads out numbers or uses medical terms.

Scoring examples: customer choice

- **Independently:** customer walks in two options and chooses.
- **With support:** compared options after a prompt.
- **Not yet:** staff member decides for the customer.

Time, kept separate

- Online learning: lessons and knowledge checks
- Workplace practice: role-plays, huddles and shifts
- Assessment: about 30 minutes for both scenarios and feedback

About the credential

Credentials are issued by BrightPath Academy. They are professional industry credentials, not government-accredited qualifications or professional licences. They are never issued on self-reported completion or on store sales results.

TOOL 7

7, 30 and 90-day reinforcement

A short check, not a repeat of the lesson. Add the three dates to your own calendar when a team member completes a skill. Reminders are not automated yet.

When	Scenario questions (5 minutes)	Practical check (5 minutes)	Date done
Day 7	Two scenario cards from Tool 4: “What would you say first? Why?”	Observe one real interaction on the rubric, one skill only	
Day 30	Two different scenario cards, including one difficult customer	Observe a full interaction on all six criteria	
Day 90	The team member chooses the hardest card and talks it through	Full observation; agree the next skill to develop	

Team member

Skill completed on

Day 7 date

Day 30 and 90 dates

TOOL 8

One-page owner review

Completed by the manager each month or at the end of a pilot, using real, authorised data only. Write “Not recorded” where data is missing. Never write zero for missing data.

Business route _____ **Store or team** _____

Period from _____ **Period to** _____

Starting capability gap	
Training and practice completed	
Skills now demonstrated (rubric)	
Next coaching priority	

Store measure	Definition	Baseline	This period	Context
Assisted-fitting conversion	Assisted fittings that ended in a purchase, divided by assisted fittings, times 100, in the same period			
Fit-related returns	Returns or exchanges recorded with a fit reason, divided by pairs sold, in the same period			
Gross profit	As reported by your own system, same definition both periods			
Time to competence	Days from start date to all six criteria Demonstrated independently			

Compare equal periods with the same definitions. Do not calculate a percentage change from a zero baseline. Results may also reflect staffing, stock, promotions or seasonality.

What remains uncertain	

Next 30-day action	